DDD-T-551K
October 19, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-T-551J
January 12, 1970

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOWEL, BATH, COTTON, TERRY

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cotton terry-cloth towels.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types, classes, and styles. The towels shall be of the following types, classes, and styles, as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Single loop

Class 1 - 20 by 40 inches (51 by 102 cm)
Class 2 - 22 by 44 inches (56 by 112 cm)
Class 3 - 16 by 27 inches (41 by 69 cm)

Type II - Double loop

Class 1 - 22 by 44 inches (56 by 112 cm)
Class 2 - 16 by 27 inches (41 by 69 cm)
Class 4 - 20 by 40 inches (51 by 102 cm)

Style A - Selvage edge both sides

Style B - One selvage edge, one hemmed edge

Style C - Hemmed edge both sides

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

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Federal Specifications:

V-T-276	-	Thread, Cotton
V-T-295	-	Thread, Nylon
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Wrapping
DDD-L-20	-	Label: For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, for Sealing and Securing

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-191	-	Textile Test Methods
FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-17757	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard (Modular Sizes)
MIL-C-43843	-	Cloth, Plain Weave, Polyester/Cotton Precured, Durable Press

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage

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(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington, DC 20580.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard sample. When a standard sample is available, the finished towel shall match the standard sample for shade, and shall be equal to or better than the standard sample with respect to all characteristics for which the standard sample is referenced (see 6.4).

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Yarn. The ground warp and filling yarns shall be cotton or polyester/cotton which may contain up to 70 percent polyester with the remaining percentage cotton. The pile warp yarns shall be made of cotton which has been spun into singles yarn. The ground warp yarns for type I towels shall be spun into singles. For type II towels, the ground warp yarns shall be spun into singles or 2 ply yarns. The filling yarns for both type towels shall be singles yarn.

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3.2.2 Thread. The thread for hemming shall conform to the requirements for type IA2 of V-T-276. The thread size for end hems shall be ticket No. 40, 3 ply or ticket No. 50, 3 ply. The thread sizes for the side hem (styles B and C only) shall be ticket No. 50, 3 ply for the needle thread and ticket No. 70, 2 ply or ticket No. 50, 3 ply for the looper thread. The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel.

3.2.2.1 Alternate nylon thread for the 401 stitch. A textured nylon thread having a breaking strength of 4.4 pounds (20 N) minimum and 10,000 yards per pound (20,200 m/kg) minimum may be used as an alternate thread for the 401 stitch. The color of the thread shall match the color of the towel. The dyed thread shall show good fastness to laundering. All testing shall be as specified in V-T-295, except that a 1.0 ounce (278 mN) pretension load shall be applied before closing the clamp in the breaking strength machine. A certificate of compliance may be accepted for these characteristics.

3.3 Color. The towels shall be bleached white or dyed, as specified (see 6.2 and 6.4.1).

3.3.1 Sulfur content. Unless specifically authorized, the use of dyes and compounds containing elementary sulfur capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuff shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed and finished towels shall contain no more labile sulfur than that shown by the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4. When a standard sample is not available, the dyed and finished towel shall show not more than a slight trace of labile sulfur as defined in the test method when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.3.2 Color matching. The color of dyed or bleached towels shall match the standard sample under natural (north sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 kelvin and shall be a good approximation to the standard sample under incandescent lamplight at 2800 kelvin.

3.3.3 Colorfastness. Dyed towels shall show fastness to combined laundering and bleaching equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is established or when the standard sample is not a reference for colorfastness, the dyed towels shall show "good" fastness to combined laundering and bleaching. The bleached towels shall show no more yellowing or discoloration than the standard sample after 20 hours exposure to light (see 4.4). When no standard sample is available, the discoloration shall be no more than the degree indicated as satisfactory when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.3.4

3.4 Physical requirements. The finished towel shall conform to the requirements of table I for the applicable type and class, when tested as specified in 4.4, 4.2.2.4 and 4.2.2.2.2.

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TABLE I. Physical requirements

Type	Class	Yarns per inch minimum		Breaking strength minimum pounds		Weight per doz, pounds minimum (conditioned) 1/	Dimensions (finished), inches	
		Warp	Filling	Warp	Filling		Width 2/ tolerance + 1/2 in (1.3 cm)	Length tolerance + 1 in (2.5 cm)
7210-00-128-8929								
I 7210-01-051-5833/		32 (13 y/cm 4/)		70 (311 N)	60 (267 N)	5.5 (2.5 kg)	20 (51 cm)	40 (102 cm)
7210-00-128-8935								
I 7210-02-057-5832/		32 (13 y/cm)		70 (311 N)	60 (267 N)	6.6 (3.0 kg)	22 (56 cm)	44 (112 cm)
I 7210-03-051-5839 3/		32 (13 y/cm)		70 (311 N)	60 (267 N)	3.0 (1.4 kg)	16 (41 cm)	27 (69 cm)
II	1	84 (33 y/cm)	42 (17 y/cm)	45 (200 N)	40 (178 N)	8.5 (3.9 kg)	22 (56 cm)	44 (112 cm)
7210-00-205-3190								
II	2	84 (33 y/cm)	42 (17 y/cm)	45 (200 N)	40 (178 N)	3.0 (1.4 kg)	16 (41 cm)	27 (69 cm)
7210-00-823-7639								
II	4	71 (28 y/cm)	32 (13 y/cm)	45 (200 N)	40 (178 N)	5.5 (2.5 kg)	20 (51 cm)	40 (102 cm)
7210-00-833-4025								
7210-00-952-5959								

1/ The towels shall reach equilibrium under Standard Conditions as defined in FED-STD-191 prior to determination of weight.

2/ Width inclusive of selvages or side hems.

3/ For type I towels, the pile warp shall be 36 (14 yarns/cm) and the ground warp shall be 36 (14 yarns/cm).

4/ Yarns per centimeter.

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3.4.1 Crimp in terry yarns. The crimp of the terry yarns shall be a minimum of 235 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.5 Shrinkage. Towels shall not shrink more than 10.0 percent in the warp and 2.0 percent in the filling when tested as specified in 4.4 (see 6.5).

3.6 Weave. The cloth shall consist of warp and filling ground yarns and warp pile yarns, woven with a terry weave, except that:

a. There shall be a border woven without terry loops, 2 ± 1/2 inches (51 ± 13 mm) wide, at each end of each towel. The measured width of the border shall include the width of the hem, or

b. There shall be a border woven without terry loops, 2 ± 1/2 inches (51 ± 13 mm) wide, placed 3-1/2 ± 1/2 inches (89 ± 13 mm) from the hem on each end of the towel. The type I towel shall be single loop (pile yarns woven singly). The type II towel shall be double loop (two pile yarns woven as one).

3.6.1 Selvage for styles A or B. The weave for the selvages shall be a 3 by 3-rib weave (two ends weaving as one) or a terry weave selvage. Each selvage shall be not less than 1/4 (6 mm) nor more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) wide.

3.6.2 Design (nonmilitary). When a woven design is required, it shall be as specified (see 6.2).

3.7 End hems. The hem at each end of the towel shall be 1/4 to 3/8 inch (6 to 10 mm) wide. Stitching shall be 1/16 to 1/8 inch (2 to 3 mm) from the turned edges, 8 to 12 stitches per inch (3 to 5 stitches/cm) using stitch type 301 or 401 and seam type EFb-1 of FED-STD-751. The hem sewn with the 301 stitch shall be backstitched at least 1/2 inch (13 mm), at the beginning and ends of the stitching. For the 401 stitch, a stitching chain 1/4 to 1/2 inch (6 to 13 mm) length shall be left at the first and last ends of the stitching or the stitches for the first and last 1/4 inch (6 mm) may be gathered at the rate of 14 to 16 stitches per inch (5-1/2 to 6 stitches/cm).

3.7.1 Side hem (style B only). One side of the towel shall be woven with a 3/4 inch (19 mm) plain border before hemming and shall be hemmed with seam type EFb-1, not less than 1/4 (6 mm) and not more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) wide, 3/16 to 1/4 inch (5 to 6 mm) stitching margin, stitch type 301 or 401, 8 to 10 stitches per inch (3 to 4 stitches/cm).

3.7.1.1 Side hems (style C only). Both sides of the towel shall be woven with a 3/4 inch (19 mm) plain border before hemming and shall be hemmed with seam type EFb-1, not less than 1/4 (6 mm) and not more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) wide, 3/16 to 1/4 inch (5 to 6 mm) stitching margin, stitch type 301 or 401, 8 to 10 stitches per inch (3 to 4 stitches/cm).

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3.8 Nonfibrous material. The finished towel shall contain not more than 2.0 percent starch and protein content including chloroform-soluble and water-soluble material, when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.9 pH. The pH value of the water extract of the finished towel shall be no less than 5.0 nor more than 8.5 when tested as specified in 4.4.

3.10 Marking.

3.10.1 Marking for identification. When marking for identification is specified (see 6.2), each towel shall be marked with the information and in the format the size of characters conforming to class 5, types III or IV of DDD-L-20, except that fastness of the markings shall be as specified for class 9 marking in 3.10.2.

3.10.2 Type I, class 1 and type II, class 4. When specified, each type I, class 1 and type II, class 4 towels shall be marked "US" in 1 inch block letters in a black medium to be centered in the border on one end of the towel. The marking shall conform to type IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20. The marking shall show good colorfastness to laundering transference; shall show fair colorfastness to accelerated laundering and shall be clearly legible after subjection to accelerated laundering.

3.11 Fiber identification. Each towel shall be labeled for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.12 Workmanship. The finished towel shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

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4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Examination of the end item.

4.2.2.1 Screening examination. The production of towels shall be visually screened by the supplier and sorted into lots designated as first and second quality (see 6.6) in accordance with standard industrial practice.

4.2.2.2 Examination for acceptance of first quality lots. Lots designated by the supplier as first quality (see 4.2.2.1) shall be examined for acceptance by the Government. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated towel. The inspection lot shall consist of all towels presented for inspection at one time.

4.2.2.2.1 Visual examination. The lot of towels shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level I of MIL-STD-105 and visually inspected. Any towel which is found to contain either or both of the following shall be classified as a defective unit:

Any Major defect listed in table II below.
More than two Minor defects listed in table II below.

The acceptable quality level (AQL) for this examination shall be 4.0 percent defective. In addition to the above, if any towel in the sample contains either or both of the following, the lot shall be rejected:

More than two of the Major defects listed in table II below.
More than five total defects (majors and minors combined).

TABLE II. Classification of visual defects

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Cut, hole, tear, or smash.	X	
Broken or missing ground warp or filling yarn*:		
Two or more contiguous regardless of length.	X	
Single, 4 inches (102 mm) or more.		X
Fine or light filling bar, light place*.	X	
Wrong draw or reed mark*.		X

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TABLE II. Classification of visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Spot, stain, or streak*:		
1 linear inch (25 mm) or more in combined directions.	X	
Less than 1 linear inch (25 mm) in combined directions.		X
Selvage:		
Missing, cut, torn, scalloped.	X	
Curled, rolled, folded.		X
Terry loops:		
8 linear inches (203 mm) or more missing in combined directions.	X	
More than 1 square inch (6.5 cm^2) missing in combined directions.	X	
Less than 8 linear inches (203 mm) missing in combined directions.		X
One square inch (6.5 cm^2) or less missing in combined directions.		X
Not formed properly*.		X
Terry pile caught in side hem.		X
Objectionable odor.		X
Color or shade not as specified.		X
Any trash, motes, leaf, or sead coat fragments.		X
Construction and workmanship:		
Wrong seam or stitch type.	X	
Stitching margin less than 3/16 (5 mm) or more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in side hems (styles B and C).		X
Loose tension, resulting in loosely secured hem.		X
Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to seam).		X
Stitches per inch:		
One or two stitches (1/2 or 1 stitch/cm) less than minimum specified.		X
Three (1.5 stitches/cm) or more stitches less than minimum specified.	X	
One (1/2 stitch/cm) or more stitches more than maximum specified.		X

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TABLE II. Classification of visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Open seam:		
More than 1 inch (25 mm) in length.	X	
1/4 to 1 inch (6 to 25 mm) in length.		X
Raw edge (but seam is not open) more than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in length.		X
Needle chew resulting in hole.	X	
Thread color not as required.	X	
Backstitching less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) at end of hem (for 301 stitching).		X
Backstitching at end of hem omitted (for 301 stitching).	X	
End of hem stitching not secured as specified (for 401 stitch).		X
Hem omitted at end of towel.	X	
Hem twisted, pleated, or puckered.		X
Width of hem at each end less than 1/4 (6 mm) or more than 3/8 inch (10 mm).		X
Width of side hem less than 1/4 (6 mm) or more than 3/8 inch (10 mm) (styles B and C).		X
Width of selvage less than 1/4 (6 mm) or more than 3/8 inch (10 mm).		X
Width of border less than 1-1/2 (38 mm) or more than 2-1/2 inches (64 mm).		X
Identification (when applicable):		
Design or marking not accomplished as specified.	X	
Design or lettering omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color, or misplaced.	X	

* Clearly visible at normal inspection distance (3 feet or 1 m).

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4.2.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. The lot of towels shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level S-3 of MIL-STD-105 and examined for compliance with dimensions specified in table I. Any dimension that is not within the tolerances specified shall be classified as a defect. The AQL for this examination shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.2.3 Examination for acceptance of second quality lots when applicable (see 6.2). Lots designated by the supplier as second quality (4.2.2.1) shall be examined for acceptance by the Government. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated towel. The inspection lot shall consist of all towels presented for inspection at one time.

4.2.2.3.1 Visual examination. The lot of towels shall be sampled in accordance with inspection level I of MIL-STD-105 and visually inspected. If any two towels in the sample are found to contain either or both of the following, the lot shall be rejected:

More than two of the major defects listed in table II above.
More than five total defects (majors and minors combined).

4.2.2.3.2 Dimensional examination. The lot of towels shall be examined for conformance with dimensional requirements in accordance with the procedures of 4.2.2.2.2.

4.2.2.4 Examination for weight. The sample size (number of sample units) shall be the same as required for dimensional examination. The lot shall be unacceptable if the weight per dozen, as computed using the following formula, is less than the minimum specified in table I.

$$\text{Weight per dozen} - \frac{\text{Total weight of sample} \times 12}{\text{Sample size (number of towels)}}$$

4.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be closed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per 100 units.

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Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as: Incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container. Inadequate securing or sealing of wrapping materials and containers. Open and noncontinuous heat sealed seams and closure of plastic bags. Omission of vent hole in plastic bag.
Content	Number of bundles per shipping container is more or less than required. Towels of different class, color, or pattern in same bundle 1/ Number of towels per bundle not as required 1/.

1/ Two bundles from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined.

4.4 Testing of the end item. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191 wherever applicable and as listed in table III shall be followed. The physical and chemical values specified in section 3 apply to the results of the determinations made on a sample unit for test purposes as specified in the applicable test method. The sample unit for testing shall be five towels. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final results. The sample size shall be as follows:

Lot size (towels)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

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TABLE III. Test methods

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test method
Fiber identification	3.2.1	1/
Polyester content for ground warp and filling	3.2.1	1/ 2/
Discoloration (bleached towels)	3.3.3	5660 3/ 4/
Yarn ply:		
Pile warp	3.2.1	Visual 4/
Ground warp	3.2.1	Visual 4/
Filling	3.2.1	Visual 4/
Yarns per inch:		
Warp	3.4	5050
Filling	3.4	5050
Breaking strength:		
Warp	3.4	5100
Filling	3.4	5100
Presence of labile sulfur	3.3.1	2020
Colorfastness (when applicable) to:		
Combined laundering and bleaching	3.3.3	5605
Light	3.3.3	5660
Crimp in terry yarns	3.4.1	4110 5/
Shrinkage	3.5	5550
Weave	3.6	Visual 4/
Nonfibrous material	3.8	2611
pH	3.9	2811

1/ Unless otherwise specified, a certificate of compliance shall be submitted and will be acceptable for the stated requirement.

2/ The polyester content shall be determined in accordance with the provisions of MIL-C-43843.

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3/ Method 5660 shall be used, except that the exposure of the specimen and standard sample shall be for 20 Standard Fading Hours. Any specimen showing discoloration less than or equal to that of the standard sample shall be rated "pass". Any specimen showing discoloration greater than that of the standard sample shall be rated "fail". When no standard sample is available the discoloration of the specimen shall be considered satisfactory if it is not worse than the rating of "fair" in the scale indicated in Method 5660.

4/ One determination shall be made from each sample unit and the results reported as "pass" or "fail".

5/ Method 4110 shall be followed except for the following:

a. The original length shall be 2 inches (51 mm) in lieu of 10 inches (254 mm) in the test procedure.

b. The jaw distance shall be set at 2 inches (51 mm) apart in lieu of 10 inches (254 mm).

c. Calculation of results shall be based on a 2 inch (51 mm) length in lieu of 10 inches (254 mm).

4.4.1

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Type I, class 1. Ten towels, of one color only, shall be individually folded or folded in pairs to an approximate size of 7-1/2 by 14-1/2 inches (191 by 368 mm), and packaged in a bundle with every two reversed. The bundle may be tied at each end with cotton tape or twine (see 6.3).

5.1.1.2 Type I, classes 2 and 3 and type II, classes 1, 2, and 4. Twelve towels, of one type, class, and color only, shall be folded to an approximate size of 9-1/4 by 14-1/2 inches (235 by 368 mm) and packaged in a bundle. The bundle may be tied at each end with cotton tape or twine (see 6.3).

5.1.1.3 All types and classes. Towels, bundled as specified in 5.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.2, shall be completely wrapped or inserted in a snug-fitting square or flat style bag of 0.00125 inch (0.03 mm) thick (± 20 percent tolerance) clear plastic film. The plastic bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous, and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The wrap or bag closure shall be effected by heat seal, wire tie, or pressure sensitive tape. Warp or bag closure shall be made as close as

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possible to the product. A 1/4 inch (6 mm) maximum diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each plastic bag to allow air to escape. Alternatively, each bundle shall be completely wrapped in 30-pound minimum basis weight (49 g/m^2) kraft paper conforming to type I, grade B of UU-P-268. The wrapping shall be secured with adhesive, or 2 inch (51 mm) minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade A of PPP-T-45.

5.1.2 Level B (civil agencies). Towels shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. Towels shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Type I, class 1. Sixty towels, of one color only, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled, closed, and reinforced conforming to class weather-resistant, grade V2s, size 3A of MIL-B-17757, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.3. The fiberboard for the box liner shall conform to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of MIL-B-17757. Level A packages shall be packed flat, three in length, one in width, and two in depth within a shipping container.

5.2.1.2 Type I, classes 2 and 3 and type II, classes 1, 2, and 4. One hundred and forty-four type I, classes 2 and 3, type II, classes 2 and 4, or ninety-six type II, class 1 towels of one color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style CSSC, FOL, or SFF, grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of PPP-B-636. Each container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspector shall be in accordance with 4.3.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Type I, class 1. Sixty towels, of one color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container assembled and closed conforming to class domestic, grade 275, size 3A of MIL-B-17757, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.3. The fiberboard for the box liner shall conform to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 of MIL-B-17757. Level A packages shall be packed flat, three in length, one in width, and two in depth within a shipping container.

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5.2.2.1.1 Weather-resistant containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with MIL-B-17757 and closed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.3.

5.2.2.2 Type I, classes 2 and 3 and type II, classes 1, 2, and 4. One hundred and forty-four type I, classes 2 and 3 or type II, classes 2 and 4, or ninety-six type II, class 1 towels of one color only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style CSSC, FOL, or SFF, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.3 (see 6.3).

5.2.3 Level C. Towels, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. The quantity per shipping container shall be the same as that used by the supplier for retail distribution. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.3 Wrapped or bagged packages. Wrapped or bagged packages shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the wrap or bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the plastic covering so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.

(a) Type I, class 1 towel is intended for use by the Medical Corps, Army, Air Force, Navy, Marine Corps and the Federal agencies.

(b) Type I, classes 2 and 3, and type II, classes 1, 2 and 4 towels are intended for use by the Federal agencies.

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6.1.1 Department of Defense. The towel authorized for procurement by the military services is type I, class 1.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options offered herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class, and style required (see 1.2).
(c) Whether bleached or dyed towel is required. If dyed, specify color (see 3.3).
(d) Whether design is required by civil agency (see 3.6.2).
(e) When marking for identification is required (see 3.10).
(f) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(g) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1.1).
(h) Type of marking required (see 5.3).

6.2.1 Quantities and distribution of accepted second quality towels shall be in accordance with the terms of the contract.

6.3 Standard pack (civil agencies). The standard pack for this commodity shall be as specified in 5.1.1.2 and 5.2.2.2. The standard pack requirements are intended for use in stores stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot, or intermediat point for temporary storage, subsequent issue, or shipment or eventual user.

6.4 Standard sample. For access to standard sample, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids (see 3.1).

6.4.1 Dyestuff formulation: Olive Green 107. A suggested but not mandatory dyestuff formulation for Olive Green 107 is as follows:

Vat Black 25, CI 69525
Vat Green 3, CI 69500
Vat Green 8, CI 71050

Shaded with either or both of the following:

Vat Brown 3, CI 69015
Vat Yellow of suitable fastness

The redness of shade should result from the predominant use of the main colors listed and not from the shading colors.

6.4.2

6.5 Drying of towels. The use of a loop dryer is suggested as a means for complying with the shrinkage requirements of 3.5.

6.6

6.7

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Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - MC, MS
DLA - CT

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

Project No. 7210-0223

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Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies of documents reference herein. cents each.

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